



Clara Poli <clara@awesomic.io>

Quick check-in - ACE Interface

8 messages

Clara Poli <clara@awesomic.io>
To: Laura Porter ACE Interface <lauraportergarden@gmail.com>
Bcc: 25125017@bcc.eu1.hubspot.com

Tue, May 19, 2026 at 3:54 PM

Hi Laura,

It's been a while since we last connected, and I wanted to reach out to see how things are going on your end.

I'd love to schedule a quick call to hear what's top of mind for your team and see where we can be most useful. One thing I've been thinking about is your website; it could be a good opportunity to refresh the look and feel, and we have designers who work a lot in that space.

Would a 20-minute call this week or next work for you?

Best,
Clara



Clara Poli

Account Manager Team Leader

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Laura Porter ACE Interface <lauraportergarden@gmail.com>
To: Clara Poli <clara@awesomic.io>

Mon, May 25, 2026 at 9:45 PM

Hi Clara - yes, a call would be a good idea.

I am still thinking about what we want in a website. I know I want a balance of art and science, and to stay with the overall look and feel in our brand guidelines. I think it might be very helpful to have some ways to explain who we are in ways that are not all words on a page.

Is it possible for someone on your team to create split-screen animations, simple line-drawing motion graphics, or AI-generated storyboard videos?

The background on the idea I am working on is: a couple of decades ago I saw two video clips back to back that illustrated the importance of "self-organizing" for system effectiveness. The first was a large crowd filling a sports arena with each individual having a ticket that they had to show to people who were positioned to help them find their seats - at each door there were two people checking tickets, then multiple more people reading tickets again and directing people to their seats. There were no visible signs - just individuals guiding individuals to seats. People didn't flow into the arena - they stood in lines that moved in a disjointed way. Then there was a second video clip that had the same size crowd filling a sports area that had very clear signage, with arrows, letters and numbers, and easy to follow larger signs that directed people to the correct section of the arena to enter - once they entered, there continued to be great signage. The crowd flowed into the arena smoothly and rapidly.

In these two videos,

The first arena system:

- depends on humans compensating for poor system design,
- creates bottlenecks,
- overwhelms workers,
- produces frustration,
- and scales badly.

The second:

- embeds intelligence into the environment,
- distributes decision-making,
- allows individuals to orient themselves,
- and produces smooth flow with far less intervention.

The Self-Healing Communities Fund is essentially trying to move communities from: high-intervention crisis sorting systems (like the first video) to conditions that support healthy self-organization at the community level (like the second video). We will help communities and states structure their people-serving systems so they can adapt, coordinate, buffer stress, and restore functioning without requiring continuous external rescue operations. With Self-Healing Communities Fund, the goal is not to manage every crisis individually. The goal is for communities to function well because the conditions for self-organization are built into the system itself in ways that reduce demand for costly public services.

I like the idea of having a video/visual contrast like this for our work because it could demonstrate — visually and intuitively — the difference between: 1) a system dependent on centralized control and constant intervention, and 2) a system designed so people can successfully self-organize within clear structures.

Perhaps the inspiration is in the "wayfinding" field?

Instead of a sports arena, for our purposes I am thinking about people flowing into a large riverfront community festival venue or park system with music, food, family gathering areas, quiet spaces, youth activities, cultural ceremonies, health resources, walking paths, community market, places for young children to laugh and play and a first-aid tent (showing that there are times when a direct service is needed). People are moving, orienting, connecting, self-directing, adapting - an image close to healthy self-organizing community life.

I asked an AI program to describe this idea in terms of a video, and this is what came out?

VIDEO 1

“Fragmented High-Friction System”

Prompt Structure

Core Prompt

Cinematic aerial and ground-level video of a very large waterfront community park during a multi-generational community festival near a river. Thousands of people arriving at sunset for music, food, art, family activities, and community gathering spaces.

The park layout is confusing and poorly designed. There are very few signs. Pathways are unclear. People repeatedly stop to ask workers and volunteers for directions. Staff members stand at every intersection giving verbal instructions. Long lines form at entrances and activity areas. Families look uncertain about where to go. Parents with children hesitate at intersections. Elderly visitors become confused. Staff are overwhelmed answering repetitive questions.

Crowd movement is slow, disjointed, and congested. Small bottlenecks create large backups. Some people accidentally enter wrong areas and must turn around. Others stand in clusters trying to orient themselves. Emergency and support staff appear increasingly stressed trying to manage crowd flow manually.

Natural beauty still exists — riverfront, trees, lights, music, gathering spaces — but the environment itself does not help people navigate or regulate. The crowd depends on constant human intervention for coordination.

Emotional tone: subtle stress, friction, cognitive overload, fragmentation, inefficiency, exhaustion.

Visual style: realistic cinematic documentary style, natural lighting, Pacific Northwest waterfront park aesthetic, warm but slightly overstimulating atmosphere.

Camera movement: slow tracking shots through congested walkways, overhead drone shots showing uneven crowd movement, closeups of repeated directional interactions, hesitant pauses, crowd friction points.

Descriptive phrases to guide quality:

- “high friction system”
- “manual coordination”
- “overloaded support workers”
- “poor wayfinding”
- “reactive management”
- “crowd congestion emerging from small design failures”
- “human systems under stress”

VIDEO 2

“Self-Organizing Healing-Centered System”

Prompt Structure

Cinematic aerial and ground-level video of the exact same large waterfront community park during the same multi-generational festival near a river at sunset.

The environment is beautifully designed for intuitive human flow and self-organization. Elegant signage, color-coded pathways, subtle lighting, landscaping, natural gathering points, clear visual markers, and welcoming orientation features gently guide people throughout the park.

Families, elders, youth, and diverse groups move smoothly and confidently toward music areas, quiet spaces, cultural gathering circles, food areas, riverside seating, children’s activities, and walking paths. People naturally find destinations without needing constant instruction.

The environment itself communicates orientation and belonging. Wide pathways reduce congestion. Trees, lighting, public art, water features, and natural design elements create calm transitions between spaces. Small informational signs and visual cues are embedded into the landscape design.

Volunteers and staff are present, but mostly welcoming and connecting rather than directing every movement. Crowd flow is adaptive, distributed, and fluid. People appear relaxed, socially connected, and emotionally regulated.

The community space feels alive, coherent, safe, and restorative. The design supports healthy self-organization rather than requiring constant intervention.

Emotional tone: calm coordination, belonging, ease, resilience, participation, human connection, distributed intelligence, community wellbeing.

Visual style: cinematic documentary realism, golden-hour lighting, warm Pacific Northwest riverfront atmosphere, emotionally grounded and authentic.

Camera movement: flowing steadicam movement following people naturally navigating spaces, wide aerial shots showing smooth distributed crowd flow, lingering shots of social connection and multi-generational participation.

Descriptive terms to guide quality: :

- “environment designed for human regulation”
- “self-organizing community flow”
- “embedded guidance”
- “distributed coordination”
- “natural wayfinding”
- “low friction environment”
- “community infrastructure supporting participation”
- “adaptive public space”
- “healing-centered civic design”

Use the SAME exact location in both videos. The difference is: system design. (not the people)

Focus in on the same family in both videos - possibly a mixed race multi-generational family

Follow: a grandparent, parent, and child.

In Video 1 they become: uncertain, stressed, repeatedly redirected, disconnected from activities.

In Video 2 they: orient naturally, connect easily, participate, and move fluidly through the environment.

We want to create emotional continuity without politicizing the message.

Closing Shot Ideas

Video 1 Ending

Overhead shot:

- crowd bottlenecks,
 - scattered confusion,
 - stressed workers,
 - fragmented flow.
-

Video 2 Ending

Overhead twilight shot:

- distributed gathering spaces glowing softly,
- pathways flowing naturally,
- music,
- riverside reflection,
- people participating calmly.

Visual emotional message:

functioning communities emerge from environments designed for healthy flow and connection.

Avoid making Video 2 feel: futuristic, overly polished, elitist, or technologically controlled.

It should feel: human, warm, local, grounded, and achievable.

The emotional power comes from: "this feels how communities are supposed to work."

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Laura Porter
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www.ACEInterface.com
lauraportergarden@gmail.com

Clara Poli <clara@awesomic.io>
To: Laura Porter ACE Interface <lauraportergarden@gmail.com>
Bcc: 25125017@bcc.eu1.hubspot.com

Tue, May 26, 2026 at 3:01 PM

Thank you for all the details, Laura!
I have a few questions to share with the internal team so we can start drafting some ideas.

Would you like this to be a standalone video, or would you like this concept included on your website?

It could work as the main header video to explain the core business. Besides that, and going back to the website redesign:

1. Would you be open to exploring creative directions on your website following your existing color palette and fonts?
2. Would you like to keep the content on the website as it is? Or do you need to rethink anything in the written content?

Once I have that information, I'll share it with the team and start ideation.

Looking forward to hearing from you,

Clara



Clara Poli

Account Manager Team Leader

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[Quoted text hidden]

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Tue, May 26, 2026 at 6:56 PM

To: Clara Poli <clara@awesomic.io>

Hi Clara,

I would like video, or whatever format we decide, to be posted on the website. And, yes, I would like to explore creative directions for a new website following your existing color palette and fonts. We don't have a website for the Self-Healing Communities Fund at this time. We will need to think through the written content. I have a team that is thinking about that now, plus I have been doing a little research about award winning or creative websites to guide my thinking.

I wrote to you about people flowing into a large riverfront community festival or park scene. One person I talked with yesterday suggested that might be too abstract for some viewers - requiring a mental translation from that scenario to our work. We are designing for the population flowing through time (life course and generations) into health, happiness, productivity. We are building a financing and management model to incentivize change from a fragmented high friction life course experience to a self-organizing healing-centered context for population wellbeing.

Another option might be people flowing into a multi-generational community campus with activities and places that more directly address human experience in the systems that communities build to support people at all ages having what it takes to promote wellbeing. That might include libraries, childcare, community gardens, community policing areas where relationships are promoted, recreation, arts, behavioral health (including formal treatment or counseling, as well as "grandmas on a bench" - lay people with basic training who promote behavioral health), markets, food stations where people can give and receive food for no or low cost, gathering circles, places for sacred activities... With this we could still show coordinated systems, overlapping supports including natural community and

professionally delivered, intergenerational interaction, self-navigation. We wouldn't want this to be a client services system map - we want it to be a community ecosystem

I am open to an idea that might take us closer to the literal work we are doing. So, it would help to have communication and design help sorting that through.

We have done a lot of public speaking about these concepts - here is a slide that I use to convey the concepts (when I am verbally explaining in a keynote, for example):



What else can I share that will be helpful in your outreach to your team?

Thank you,
Laura Porter
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Clara Poli <clara@awesomic.io>
To: Laura Porter ACE Interface <lauraportergarden@gmail.com>
Bcc: 25125017@bcc.eu1.hubspot.com

Wed, May 27, 2026 at 3:53 PM

Hi Laura,

Thank you for sharing all of this; it gives us a lot to work with!

I'd like to suggest starting with the website and then moving to the video once we have a visual direction established. That way, the video follows the same style and feels like a natural extension of the site rather than a separate asset.

For the website, I want to pick up the concept you described - the contrast between a fragmented, high-friction system and a self-organizing, healing-centered one - and use it as the backbone of the experience. Not just as content, but as a design principle: how the site feels to navigate, how information is layered, how visitors orient themselves. The working name I'd use internally is "wayfinding as mission" - the site itself should demonstrate what you're trying to build.

Once that direction is defined, we can apply the same visual language to the video.

I already have the brand guidelines on file, so we're good there.

If this approach works for you, I can go ahead and get everything set up on our end through the Awesomic platform so we can get started.

Just let me know!
Clara



Clara Poli

Account Manager Team Leader

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Laura Porter ACE Interface <lauraportergarden@gmail.com>

Wed, May 27, 2026 at 4:05 PM

To: Clara Poli <clara@awesomic.io>

Yes, I like that direction. I appreciate your guidance and help.
Please let me know what is needed from me or our team,
Laura

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Clara Poli <clara@awesomic.io>

Wed, May 27, 2026 at 4:21 PM

To: Laura Porter ACE Interface <lauraportergarden@gmail.com>

Bcc: 25125017@bcc.eu1.hubspot.com

Hi Laura, one thing that is not clear to me.

Do you want a separate website for the Self-Healing Communities Fund? Or do you want this to be a page inside of your existing page?

My initial thought is to first redesign your existing website (<https://www.aceinterface.com/>) with a modern look and feel, and then add a new section page for the Self-Healing Communities Fund. But let me know if I understood correctly or if you were thinking of something different.

Thanks!

Clara



Clara Poli

Account Manager Team Leader

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Laura Porter ACE Interface <lauraportergarden@gmail.com>

Wed, May 27, 2026 at 4:58 PM

To: Clara Poli <clara@awesomic.io>

I would like a separate website, no need to update the ACE Interface website.

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